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SURABHI: *What does the National Cooling Action Plan involve?*

Some measures relate to behavioural changes, which would include working hours and working patterns.

Some measures concern capacity building such as increasing cooling capacity and developing industries that can provide cooling solutions.

There is also the need for a joint mechanism, where the central government and the state governments work together on preventive measures.

We are working on all three action plans simultaneously.

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SZ: *Air pollution is clearly a complicated issue. Should we expect that this problem will ever truly end?*

The first area we examined was vehicle pollution. To address this, you would have noticed that we have upgraded fuel categories. In the previous Cabinet meeting itself, the Central Government approved a new incentive scheme worth ₹10,000 crore for commercial vehicles.

Another aspect is smart traffic management. In Delhi, we have already identified sixty-two locations where traffic congestion is

particularly severe. We have instructed authorities to improve these areas before October, because smoother traffic movement will naturally help reduce pollution.

The second major source of pollution is dust. We launched an initiative where we said that while trees should certainly be planted, local grasses and shrubs native to Delhi should also be planted in open spaces.

sector, India continues to move forward.

In the renewable energy sector, the International Solar Alliance now has its headquarters in Gurugram.

To address disasters arising from climate change, India established the Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure, which is another climate action initiative, and its headquarters is also located here.

Similarly, for hard-to-abate industries—

conservation. Although one of its programmes was postponed due to certain reasons, the objective remains to preserve biodiversity balance.

Therefore, we believe that climate discussions cannot be limited to negotiations alone.

Countries must engage in knowledge sharing, capacity building, innovation and mutual support to implement effective climate action programmes.

PEOPLE OFTEN TELL US THAT INDIA RANKS FOURTH IN POLLUTION. WE RESPOND THAT THEY SHOULD LOOK AT PER CAPITA CONSUMPTION

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SURABHI: *Climate finance is a major topic of discussion. We have seen Green Bonds, and the government is working on a Green Taxonomy. What additional measures can be taken?*

India is expanding its own capabilities. Whether we are talking about green sovereign funds, carbon credit schemes, green credit mechanisms, or expanding our capacity in the solar renewable

those sectors with high carbon emissions such as steel, aluminium, mining and transport—India, together with Sweden, launched the Leadership for Industrial Transition initiative as a climate action programme.

To further expand capacities, India has also participated in the International Biofuel Alliance as part of its climate action initiatives. There is also the International Big Cat Alliance for biodiversity

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SZ: *How do you expect corporate India to contribute to sustainable development?*

I have one suggestion for everyone. We should dedicate a portion of our profits towards research, innovation, skill development and capacity building. In the future, good technology, strong skills and enhanced capacity will provide the solutions. **BT**

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